Survey Report on

FACTORS INFLUENCING PEOPLE TO TAKE UP ENTREPRENEURSHIP

INTRODUCTION

The data for this study were collected using the **Questionnaire Method**. An online questionnaire was carefully designed and circulated among undergraduate students from various colleges across India. Within a period of 15 days,**137 response**s were gathered before filtering, and a total of 134 responses were taken into account. The questionnaire aimed to capture the various factors that influenced the career choice of the current generation.
An overall overview of the data collected before delving deep into the analysis is given below:
The respondents are between the ages of 19-30. There are 72 males and 63 female respondents. Out of 137 respondents, 49 are undergraduates, 18 are high schoolers, and 5 are postgraduates.
The analysis of the collected data was aimed at uncovering the factors that influence the career choice of the current generation.

OBJECTIVES

The key objective here is to evaluate the socioeconomic and cultural factors shaping these preferences. The study investigates how family income levels, educational streams (e.g., Commerce, Science), and urban-rural residency influence career decisions. For instance, it explores whether respondents from lower-income households prioritize government jobs for financial security, while high-income groups lean toward entrepreneurship or international mobility. Additionally, the research assesses perceptions about the quality of education and work environments abroad versus India, probing whether aspirational choices align with realistic assessments of global opportunities or stem from idealized views of foreign systems.

METHODOLOGY

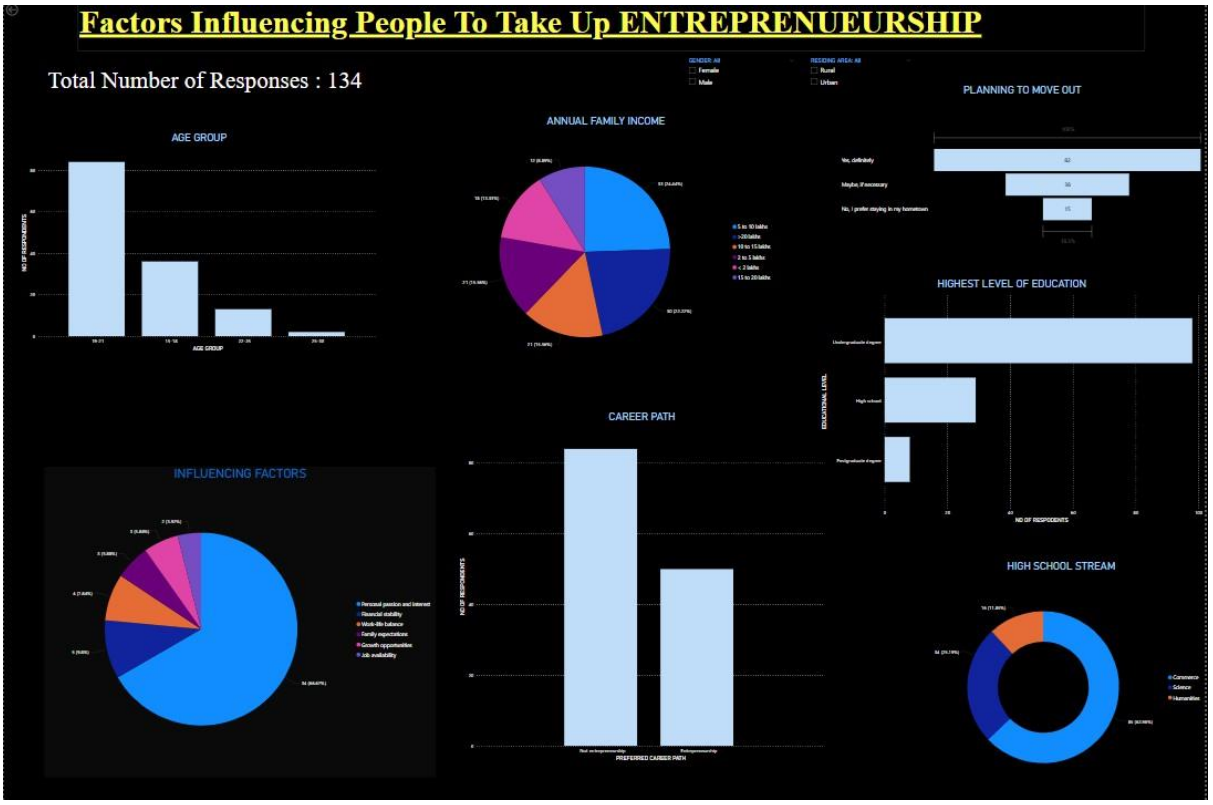
This report adopts a descriptive and analytical research methodology to interpret the career preferences of Indian youth. Descriptive research focuses on summarizing observed trends and patterns within the collected dataset, while analytical research delves into identifying relationships between variables (e.g., income levels and career choices). This dual approach allows the study to not only catalog prevalent preferences but also uncover underlying socioeconomic and cultural drivers shaping these decisions.
The methodology is structured around mixed-method analysis, combining quantitative techniques (statistical comparisons, frequency distributions) with qualitative thematic insights. By anchoring the analysis in comparative frameworks, the methodology ensures a systematic exploration of how external factors influence career aspirations

The primary data for this research was collected through a structured online questionnaire. The questionnaire comprised 16 questions, including closed-ended multiple-choice questions

(e.g., age group, income brackets, career paths) and Likert-scale responses (e.g., willingness to relocate, perceptions of education quality). Questions were categorized into four themes: demographics (age, gender, education, location), socioeconomic factors (income, stream), career aspirations (preferred paths, work style preferences), and global mobility (interest in studying/working abroad).

This method was chosen for its accessibility, real-time data aggregation, and ability to maintain respondent anonymity. Over a two-week period, 137 valid responses were collected, predominantly from urban areas (85%) and the 19–21 age group (70%), reflecting the study's focus on youth aspirations.

ANALYSIS:



The survey revealed that the majority of respondents interested in entrepreneurship fall within the 18-21 **age group**. This suggests that the inclination toward entrepreneurial ventures begins quite early, typically during the undergraduate years when individuals are exploring various career possibilities. The younger demographic appears to be increasingly aware of entrepreneurship as a viable and attractive career choice compared to traditional employment.

In terms of **financial background**, a significant portion of the participants reported annual family incomes within the range of ₹5 to ₹15 lakh. This range indicates a middle to upper-middle-class economic background, suggesting that financial security at home may provide a supportive cushion for individuals willing to take the risks associated with starting a business. It is noteworthy that entrepreneurship is being considered not just by the very affluent but also by those from moderately stable families.

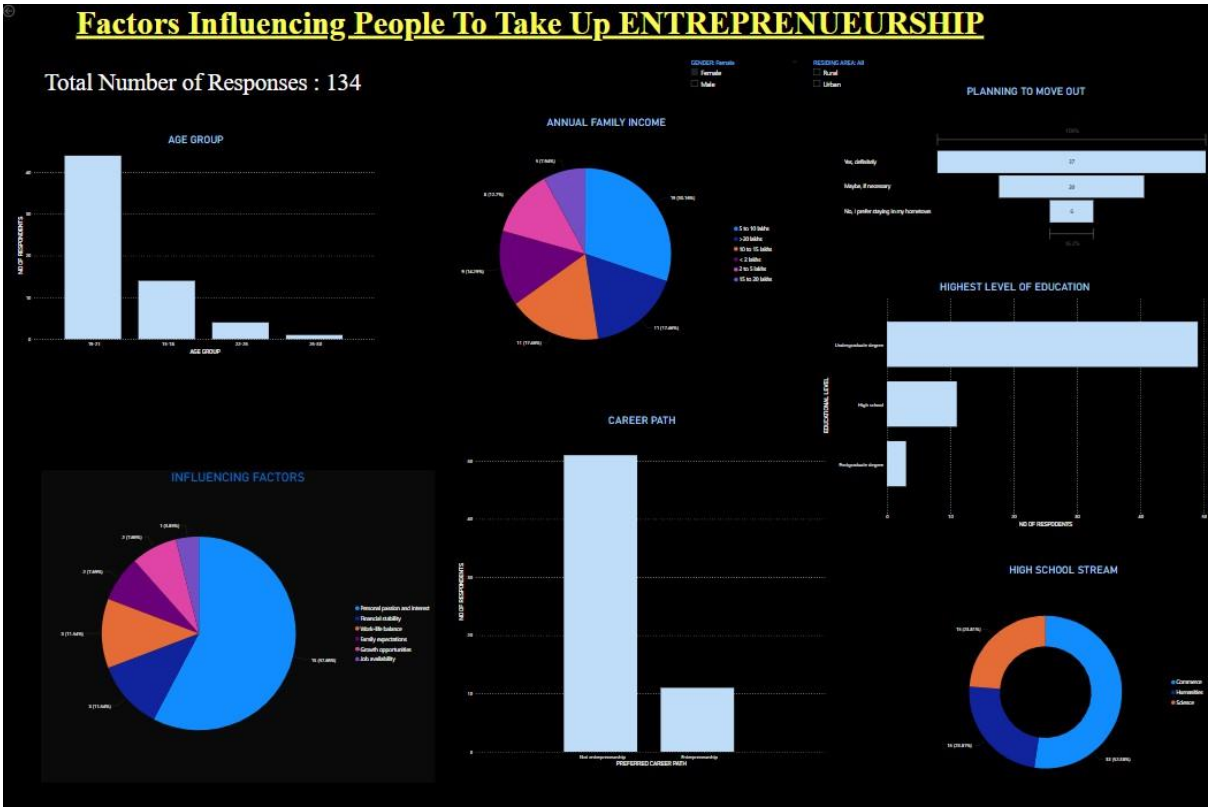
The **educational qualifications** of the respondents further reinforce the idea that higher education plays a critical role in fostering entrepreneurial aspirations. A majority of the individuals surveyed were pursuing or had already completed an undergraduate degree. Additionally, their high school academic streams were largely divided between Commerce and Science, both fields traditionally associated with logical reasoning, strategic thinking, and innovation — qualities essential for entrepreneurial success.

When asked about their preferred **career path**, a significant group indicated a strong preference for entrepreneurship over conventional employment. This highlights a broader

societal shift toward valuing independence, innovation, and self-initiative. Entrepreneurship is increasingly seen as a means of personal and professional fulfillment rather than just an alternative to unemployment.

The analysis of **influencing factors** revealed that personal passion and interest were the most dominant motivators behind the decision to pursue entrepreneurship. Many respondents emphasized the desire to follow their dreams and build something meaningful. Financial stability was the second most significant factor, indicating that while passion is essential, pragmatic financial considerations also play a crucial role. Other factors such as family expectations, the availability of job opportunities, and growth prospects were comparatively less influential but still noteworthy.

The survey explored respondents' willingness to **relocate** in pursuit of entrepreneurial opportunities. A considerable proportion of the participants expressed a readiness to move out of their hometowns if necessary. This openness to relocation reflects the flexibility and adaptability that are often crucial for entrepreneurial success, especially when opportunities are geographically concentrated in urban or emerging business hubs.



In terms of gender, the dashboard indicates a higher participation of males compared to females. However, the enthusiasm for entrepreneurship was observed across both genders, suggesting that while males currently dominate in numbers, females are equally engaged and motivated in their entrepreneurial pursuits.

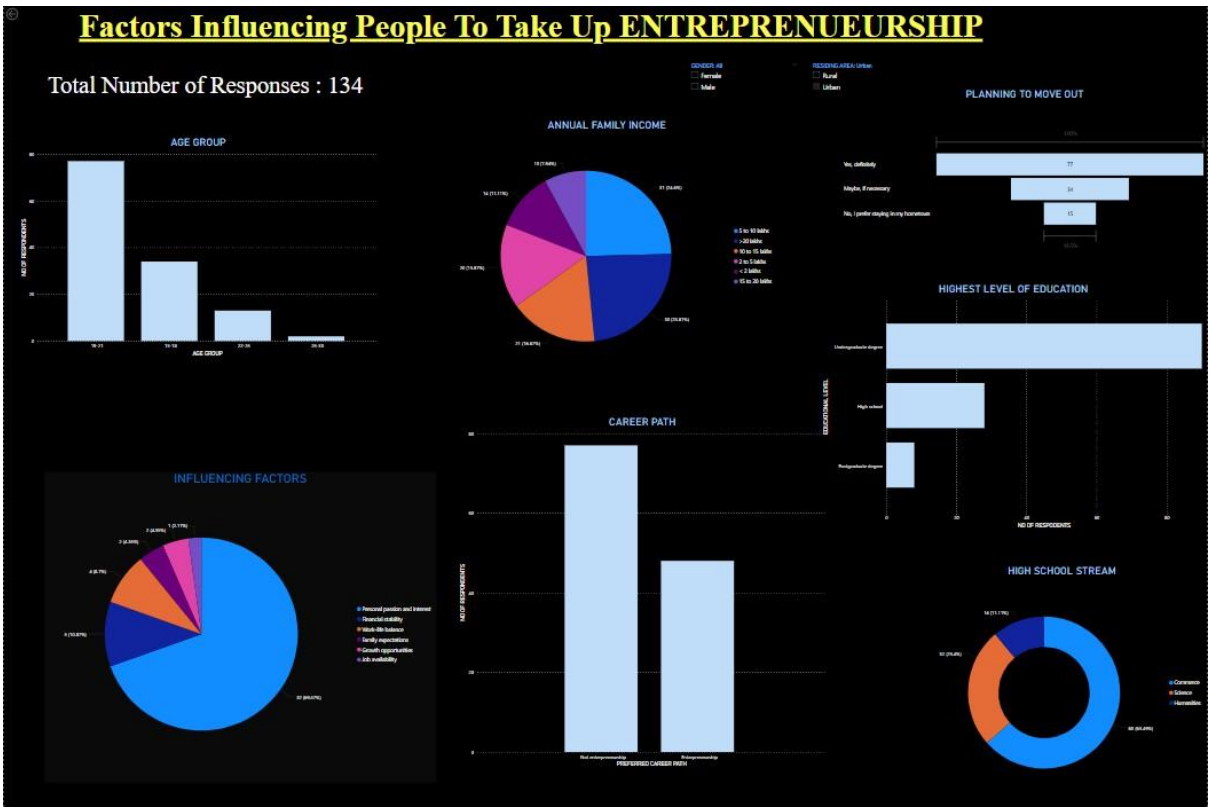
However, the distribution of **income groups** also showed notable participation from lower and higher income segments, reflecting that entrepreneurial ambition transcends financial boundaries. Among females, a significant share also came from this middle-income bracket, implying that family financial security boosts entrepreneurial confidence for both genders.

A smaller section had completed high **school** or were in the process of attaining postgraduate degrees. Interestingly, male and female respondents predominantly belonged to the undergraduate category, reaffirming that the undergraduate phase catalyzes entrepreneurial aspirations. Notably, female respondents also showed a considerable presence in the Commerce stream, indicating a rising trend of women aligning themselves with business-oriented disciplines early on.

The analysis of **career paths** highlighted a strong preference towards entrepreneurship. A significant proportion of respondents, cutting across gender lines, expressed a desire to start their ventures rather than opt for traditional job roles. Although males formed the larger part of this group, the number of females aiming to be entrepreneurs was promising and indicative of changing societal norms that encourage women to lead their businesses.

In terms of **motivating factors**, personal passion and interest emerged as the most significant driving force behind the decision to take up entrepreneurship. However, a slightly higher inclination toward financial stability as a motivating factor was noticed among female respondents, possibly reflecting practical considerations and a cautious approach towards career decisions.

A large portion of respondents showed openness to **relocation** if it facilitated better entrepreneurial opportunities. Among these, males showed slightly greater willingness compared to females, although a considerable number of female respondents also expressed readiness to move if necessary. This readiness to step out of comfort zones highlights the serious commitment and ambition among young aspiring entrepreneurs across genders.



The analysis begins with the **age distribution** of respondents, where the majority fall within the 18–21 age bracket, followed by the 22–25 group. The representation significantly tapers off beyond age 25, confirming that entrepreneurial ambition tends to surface prominently among young adults. This youthful inclination is observed consistently across both genders and residential areas, though urban residents form the larger share in the younger categories.

The **gender composition**, marked separately for rural and urban respondents, shows a slightly higher male representation, yet female participation remains strong and noteworthy. Notably, urban females show higher engagement in entrepreneurial thinking compared to their rural counterparts, indicating greater exposure and opportunities in cities.

Annual family income patterns reveal that most participants come from middle-income households, specifically in the ₹5–10 lakh range. Interestingly, both rural and urban areas show presence in this bracket, although urban families are more represented in the higher income categories above ₹10 lakh. This suggests that financial backing, while helpful, is not the sole driver, as lower-income groups are also present among aspiring entrepreneurs.

The **education levels** of respondents further underscore the trend, with most individuals either holding or pursuing undergraduate degrees. A smaller portion has completed high school, and even fewer possess postgraduate qualifications. Urban respondents dominate the higher education segments, while rural participation is more visible at the high school level. This indicates that urban environments likely provide better access to educational and entrepreneurial resources.

The **high school academic stream** analysis reveals that Commerce is the most chosen field, followed by Science and then Humanities. Urban respondents, especially females, dominate the Commerce stream, reflecting early career alignment with business and finance. Rural representation is comparatively lower but balanced across streams.

In terms of **career paths**, a significant number of respondents express a desire to create something of their own. Males, particularly from urban areas, show a higher tilt toward entrepreneurship, though female interest—especially among urban residents—is also growing steadily. Rural respondents lean slightly more toward job security, yet a notable segment is inclined toward independent ventures.

When examining **motivational factors**, "Personal passion and interest" is by far the most influential reason for pursuing entrepreneurship, cited by over half the respondents. "Financial stability" and "Growth opportunities" follow distantly. Interestingly, rural respondents rate "Financial stability" and "Job unavailability" higher than their urban peers, indicating more practical concerns driven by environmental limitations. Urban females, meanwhile, place added value on "Work-life balance," suggesting a shift in entrepreneurial motivations from pure financial reasons to lifestyle aspirations.

The **willingness to relocate** data shows that a majority (77 respondents) are open to moving out of their hometowns, reflecting flexibility and ambition. A smaller group (18 respondents) would consider moving if necessary, while only 15 prefer staying local. Urban participants show stronger openness to relocation, likely due to exposure and mobility. Rural males are somewhat more reluctant, possibly influenced by familial obligations or limited infrastructure in potential destinations.

RECCOMENDATIONS:

Leverage Personal Passion and Purpose

- Encourage passion mapping exercises in schools, colleges, and community programs to help individuals connect their interests with real-world problems they could solve.

Offer Gender-Sensitive Support

- Empower female respondents—who show strong entrepreneurial inclination—by offering safe spaces, mentorship programs with women entrepreneurs, and seed funding opportunities tailored to overcome gender-specific challenges.

Bridge the Urban-Rural Motivation Gap

- Provide access to micro-financing, local incubators, and digital tools to ease the infrastructure and resource gap.

Cultivate Entrepreneurship Among Students

- Organize student innovation contests or ideation challenges with tangible rewards like internships, co-working spaces, or startup funding.

Highlight Flexible and Growth-Oriented Lifestyles

- Since many are willing to move out and explore, frame entrepreneurship as a flexible and growth-rich alternative to traditional careers. Showcase freedom, impact, and learning as rewards.Reinforce that failure is a part of the journey and create support structures like counseling or mentorship to reduce fear and anxiety.

CONCLUSION:

The collective findings from the dashboard analysis reveal that entrepreneurship is increasingly favored by young individuals, especially those between 18 and 25 years of age. The drive is largely rooted in personal passion, followed by aspirations for financial independence and growth opportunities. Gender and geography play important yet nuanced roles: urban youth, particularly females, show higher entrepreneurial inclination compared to their rural counterparts, who are slightly more inclined toward stable jobs due to practical constraints.

Educational background also influences entrepreneurial ambition—most respondents are undergraduates from commerce and science streams, suggesting early exposure to business and analytical thinking. Middle-income families form the majority, indicating that moderate financial stability can foster entrepreneurial aspirations. A significant number of respondents are willing to relocate, highlighting openness to opportunity and adaptability.

Overall, the data reflects a shift in mindset among the younger generation—towards self-driven career paths, innovation, and breaking away from conventional employment structures.

APPENDIX 1:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1CecYUhyrZ8AgpjAeOqmlnRecqmrsR7iX/view?usp=sharing

APPENDIX 2:

